

PAULT DOCUMENTATION

2026 01 27 Ui Overhaul Design

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Theme: Clean Technical

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Pault UI Overhaul Design

> **Status: COMPLETED** — All design goals implemented. See [2026-01-27-ui-overhaul-implementation.md](#) for the task-level plan.

Overview

A full visual overhaul to give Pault a native macOS feel with modern patterns: auto-hiding sidebar, tag-based organization, always-editable content, and a collapsible inspector panel.

Architecture & Layout

Overall Structure

Use `NavigationSplitView` with a two-column layout:

- **Sidebar** (left): Smart filters + flat prompt list with tag pills
- **Detail** (right): Prompt editor with collapsible inspector

Sidebar Behavior

- Auto-hides when a prompt is selected
- Reappears on hover near left edge (20pt trigger zone)
- Manual toggle via toolbar button or Cmd++@
- Uses native translucent sidebar material

Window

- Resizable (no longer fixed size)
- Minimum size: 700×500
- Remembers last size/position

Layout Diagram

[illegible]

Sidebar Details

Smart Filters (top section)

Fixed items that filter the prompt list:

- **Search field** — filters by title, content, or tag name as you type
- **Recently Used** — last 10 prompts accessed (based on `updatedAt`)
- **All Prompts** — shows everything except archived
- **Archived** — shows only archived prompts

Selected filter is highlighted. Only one active at a time (search overrides others while typing).

Prompt List (below filters)

- Flat list, no section headers
- Each row shows:
- Title (or first ~30 chars of content if untitled)
- Tag pills inline (small, colored, max 2 visible + "+N" overflow)
- Subtle favorite star if favorited
- Single-click selects and opens in detail view
- Right-click context menu: Copy, Favorite/Unfavorite, Archive/Unarchive, Delete

Tags

- Displayed as small rounded pills (e.g., `#work`, `#email`)
- Clicking a tag in the list filters to show only prompts with that tag
- Tag colors auto-assigned from a preset palette (or user-customizable later)

Empty States

- No prompts: "No prompts yet. Click + to create one."
- No search results: "No prompts match your search."
- No archived: "No archived prompts."

Detail View & Editor

Layout

The detail area has two parts:

- **Editor** (main area) — title and content, always editable
- **Inspector panel** (right side) — collapsible metadata panel

Editor

- **Title field** at top: Large font (`.title2`), placeholder "Untitled", no visible border until focused
- **Content area** below: Full-height `TextEditor`, clean appearance, subtle background on focus
- Auto-saves on every change (debounced ~500ms to avoid excessive writes)
- No Save button needed—changes persist automatically

Inspector Panel

- Toggle visibility with  button in bottom-right corner (or Cmd++I)
- Slides in/out from the right edge
- Width: ~220pt fixed
- Contains:
 - **Tags** — editable tag pills with inline "+" to add new tags
 - **Favorite toggle** — star button
 - **Created date** — read-only
 - **Modified date** — read-only
 - **Archive button** — moves prompt to/from archive

No Selection State

When no prompt is selected (and sidebar is hidden), show a minimal welcome view:

- "Select a prompt or press Cmd++N to create one"
- Keyboard shortcut hint

Data Model Changes

Current Model

- Prompt: title, content, isFavorite, isArchived, createdAt, updatedAt, category (single Category)
- Category: name, prompts (inverse relationship)

New Model

Replace Category with Tag:

- Prompt: title, content, isFavorite, isArchived, createdAt, updatedAt, **tags** (many-to-many with Tag)
- Tag: name, color (optional), prompts (inverse relationship)

Migration

- Existing categories become tags automatically
- Each prompt's single category converts to a one-item tag array
- No data loss

Color Palette for Tags

Preset colors (user picks when creating, or auto-assigned):

- Blue, Purple, Pink, Red, Orange, Yellow, Green, Teal, Gray

Toolbar & Keyboard Shortcuts

Toolbar (unified, no duplicates)

Three items, left to right:

- **Toggle Sidebar** (leading) — `sidebar.left` icon, Cmd++0

- **Copy** (trailing) — doc . on . doc icon, Cmd++C when prompt selected, disabled otherwise
- **New Prompt** (trailing) — plus icon, Cmd++N

No Save button (auto-save handles it). No Edit button (always editable).

Keyboard Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
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Cmd++N	New prompt
Cmd++C	Copy prompt content (when detail view focused)
Cmd++0	Toggle sidebar
Cmd++I	Toggle inspector panel
Cmd++F	Focus search field
Cmd++Delete	Archive selected prompt
Delete	Delete prompt (with confirmation)
Escape	Deselect prompt / close inspector

Summary of Changes

Area	Current	New
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Layout	Manual HStack	NavigationSplitView
Sidebar	Always visible, fixed width	Auto-hide + hover reveal + manual toggle
Organization	Category sections	Smart filters + flat list with tags
Data model	Single category per prompt	Multiple tags per prompt
Editing	Edit mode toggle	Always editable, auto-save
Metadata	Inline in form	Collapsible inspector panel
Toolbar	Duplicated across views	Single unified toolbar

Files to Create/Modify

New Files

- Pault/Tag.swift — new Tag model
- Pault/SidebarView.swift — extracted sidebar with filters and list
- Pault/InspectorView.swift — collapsible metadata panel
- Pault/TagPillView.swift — reusable tag pill component
- Pault/SearchField.swift — search filter component

Modified Files

- `Pault/Prompt.swift` — replace category with tags relationship
- `Pault/ContentView.swift` — refactor to `NavigationSplitView`, unified toolbar
- `Pault/PromptDetailView.swift` — simplify to editor + inspector toggle
- `Pault/PaultApp.swift` — update schema, remove fixed window size

Deleted Files

- `Pault/Category.swift` — replaced by `Tag`
- `Pault/WindowSizeConstraints.swift` — no longer needed (window is resizable)